

CHINA, COMMUNISM AND ASIA

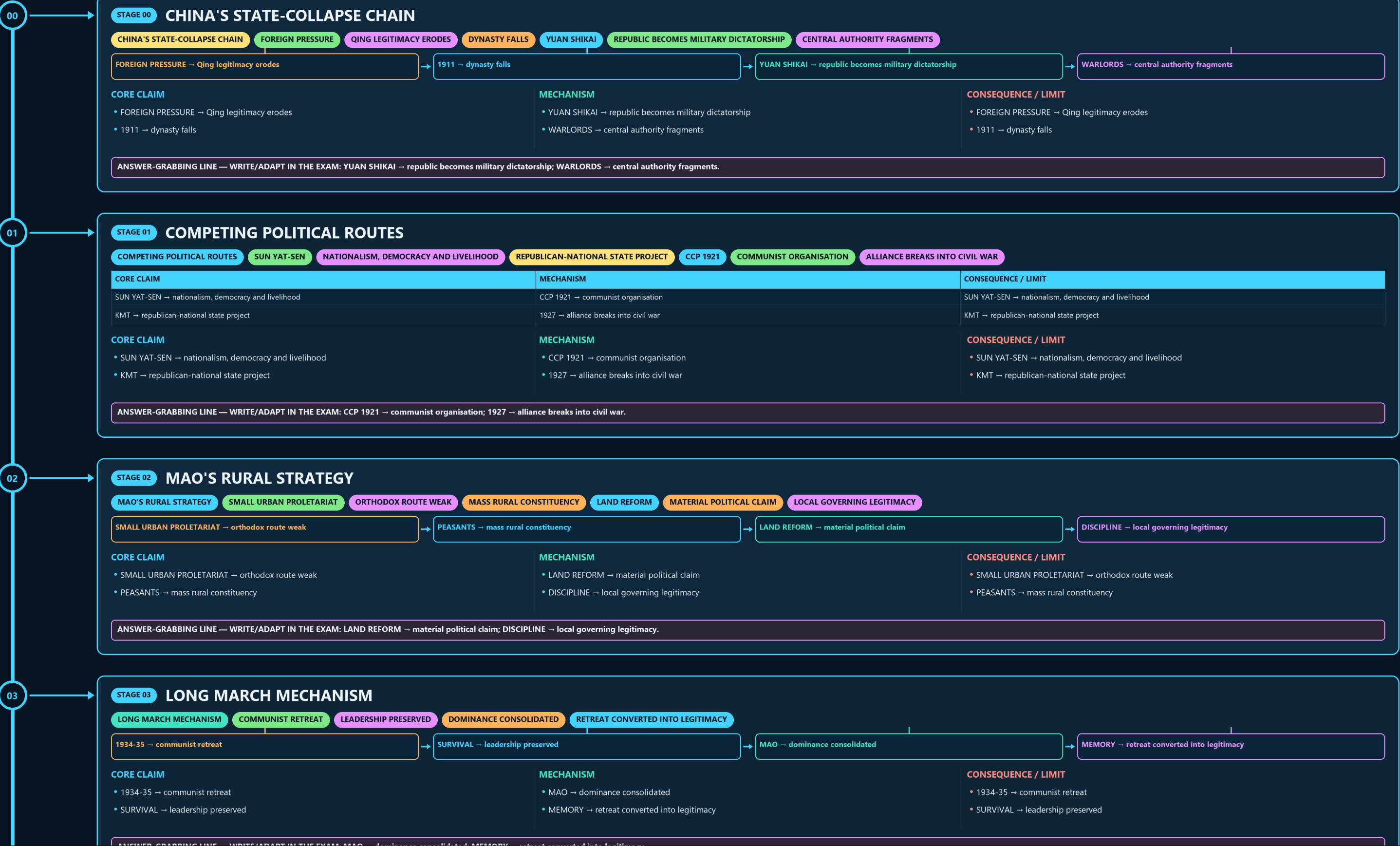
CHINA'S STATE-COLLAPSE CHAIN → COMPETING POLITICAL ROUTES → MAO'S RURAL STRATEGY → LONG MARCH MECHANISM → WHY THE CCP WON → MAO-ERA BALANCE SHEET

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



03

• SMALL URBAN PROLETARIAT → orthodox route weak

• PEASANTS → mass rural constituency

• LAND REFORM → material political claim

• DISCIPLINE → local governing legitimacy

• SMALL URBAN PROLETARIAT → orthodox route weak

• PEASANTS → mass rural constituency

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LAND REFORM → material political claim; DISCIPLINE → local governing legitimacy.

STAGE 03

LONG MARCH MECHANISM

LONG MARCH MECHANISM

COMMUNIST RETREAT

LEADERSHIP PRESERVED

DOMINANCE CONSOLIDATED

RETREAT CONVERTED INTO LEGITIMACY

1934-35 → communist retreat

→

SURVIVAL → leadership preserved

→

MAO → dominance consolidated

→

MEMORY → retreat converted into legitimacy

CORE CLAIM

• 1934-35 → communist retreat

• SURVIVAL → leadership preserved

MECHANISM

• MAO → dominance consolidated

• MEMORY → retreat converted into legitimacy

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• 1934-35 → communist retreat

• SURVIVAL → leadership preserved

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MAO → dominance consolidated; MEMORY → retreat converted into legitimacy.

04

STAGE 04

WHY THE CCP WON

WHY THE CCP WON

CORRUPTION, INFLATION AND POOR ADMINISTRATION

DISCIPLINE, LAND REFORM AND PEASANT CONTACT

JAPANESE WAR

KMT BURDEN RISES

MAO PROCLAIMS PRC; CHIANG RETREATS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
KMT → corruption, inflation and poor administration	JAPANESE WAR → KMT burden rises	KMT → corruption, inflation and poor administration
CCP → discipline, land reform and peasant contact	1949 → Mao proclaims PRC; Chiang retreats	CCP → discipline, land reform and peasant contact

CORE CLAIM

• KMT → corruption, inflation and poor administration

• CCP → discipline, land reform and peasant contact

MECHANISM

• JAPANESE WAR → KMT burden rises

• 1949 → Mao proclaims PRC; Chiang retreats

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• KMT → corruption, inflation and poor administration

• CCP → discipline, land reform and peasant contact

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CCP → discipline, land reform and peasant contact.

05

STAGE 05

MAO-ERA BALANCE SHEET

MAO-ERA BALANCE SHEET

UNITY AND LANDLORD POWER WEAKENED

HUNDRED FLOWERS

CRITICISM FOLLOWED BY REPRESSION

GREAT LEAP

COMMUNES, DISRUPTION AND FAMINE

CULTURAL REVOLUTION

EDUCATION AND ADMINISTRATION DAMAGED

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CONSOLIDATION → unity and landlord power weakened	GREAT LEAP → communes, disruption and famine	CONSOLIDATION → unity and landlord power weakened
HUNDRED FLOWERS → criticism followed by repression	CULTURAL REVOLUTION → education and administration damaged	HUNDRED FLOWERS → criticism followed by repression

CORE CLAIM

• CONSOLIDATION → unity and landlord power weakened

• HUNDRED FLOWERS → criticism followed by repression

MECHANISM

• GREAT LEAP → communes, disruption and famine

• CULTURAL REVOLUTION → education and administration damaged

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• CONSOLIDATION → unity and landlord power weakened

• HUNDRED FLOWERS → criticism followed by repression

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GREAT LEAP → communes, disruption and famine; CULTURAL REVOLUTION → education and administration damaged.

06

STAGE 06

GREAT LEAP MECHANISM

GREAT LEAP MECHANISM

CRASH TARGETS

ADMINISTRATIVE PRESSURE RISES

RURAL PRODUCTION REORGANISED

FEEDBACK FAILS

ERROR TRAVELS UPWARD

SEVERE DISRUPTION AND FAMINE

CRASH TARGETS → administrative pressure rises

→

COMMUNES → rural production reorganised

→

FEEDBACK FAILS → error travels upward

→

RESULT → severe disruption and famine

CORE CLAIM

• CRASH TARGETS → administrative pressure rises

• COMMUNES → rural production reorganised

MECHANISM

• FEEDBACK FAILS → error travels upward

• RESULT → severe disruption and famine

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• CRASH TARGETS → administrative pressure rises

• COMMUNES → rural production reorganised

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FEEDBACK FAILS → error travels upward; RESULT → severe disruption and famine.

CHINA, COMMUNISM AND ASIA • TILE 2/4 • same master rows 2333-5567 of 10234 • continues below

- HUNDRED FLOWERS → criticism followed by repression

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GREAT LEAP — communes, disruption and famine; CULTURAL REVOLUTION — education and administration damaged.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FEEDBACK FAILS → error travels upward; RESULT → severe disruption and famine.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ADMINISTRATION → authority destabilised; SOCIAL ORDER → prolonged damage, 1966-76.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: POLITICS → one-party rule retained; 1989 → force blocks political liberalisation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAMBODIA → Khmer Rouge extremism; LAOS → durable one-party pragmatic adjustment.

09

STAGE 09 ASIAN COMMUNIST DIVERSITY

ASIAN COMMUNIST DIVERSITY NORTH KOREA DIVISION AND EXTREME CENTRALISATION ANTI-COLONIAL NATIONALISM PLUS COMMUNISM KHMER ROUGE EXTREMISM DURABLE ONE-PARTY PRAGMATIC ADJUSTMENT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
NORTH KOREA → division and extreme centralisation	CAMBODIA → Khmer Rouge extremism	NORTH KOREA → division and extreme centralisation
VIETNAM → anti-colonial nationalism plus communism	LAOS → durable one-party pragmatic adjustment	VIETNAM → anti-colonial nationalism plus communism
CORE CLAIM • NORTH KOREA → division and extreme centralisation • VIETNAM → anti-colonial nationalism plus communism	MECHANISM • CAMBODIA → Khmer Rouge extremism • LAOS → durable one-party pragmatic adjustment	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT • NORTH KOREA → division and extreme centralisation • VIETNAM → anti-colonial nationalism plus communism

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAMBODIA → Khmer Rouge extremism; LAOS → durable one-party pragmatic adjustment.

10

STAGE 10 SINO-SOVIET SPLIT

SINO-SOVIET SPLIT TREATY OF FRIENDSHIP AND ASSISTANCE AFTER 1956 DOCTRINE, AID AND TERRITORY DIVIDE CHINA ATTACKS SOVIET-ALIGNED VIETNAM FORMAL RECONCILIATION IN BEIJING

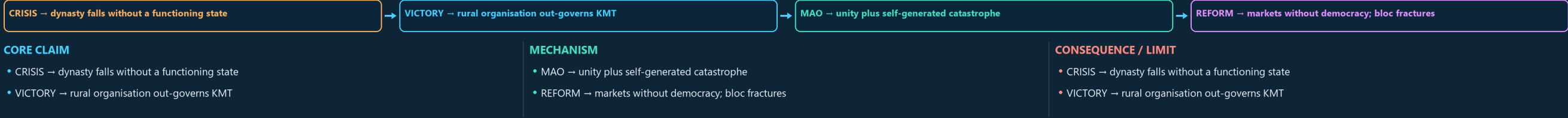


ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: AFTER 1956 → doctrine, aid and territory divide.

11

STAGE 11 CHINA ANSWER SPINE

CHINA ANSWER SPINE DYNASTY FALLS WITHOUT A FUNCTIONING STATE RURAL ORGANISATION OUT-GOVERNS KMT UNITY PLUS SELF-GENERATED CATASTROPHE MARKETS WITHOUT DEMOCRACY; BLOC FRACTURES



ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CRISIS → dynasty falls without a functioning state.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT LOWE ARGUES IN EFFECT THAT MAO GAVE CHINA UNITY BUT AT A HUGE HUMAN AND INSTITUTIONAL COST WHEN DENG ALLOWED MARKET INCENTIVES, FOREIGN INVESTMENT AND AGRICULTURAL DECOLLECTIVIZATION. ECONOMIC PRAGMATISM REPLACED PERMANENT MASS CAMPAIGN POLITICS. YET THE COMMUNIST PARTY REMAINED THE UNQUESTIONED POLITICAL CENTRE. TIANANMEN IN 1989 PROVED THAT ECONOMIC OPENING DID NOT THIS IS A CLASSIC UPSC CONTRAST

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH • CAUTION: Lowe argues in effect that Mao gave China unity, independence and revolutionary purpose, but at a huge human and institutional cost when campaigns displaced administrative rationality. • Deng allowed market incentives, foreign investment and agricultural decollectivization. • Economic pragmatism replaced permanent mass campaign politics.	ADVANCED DEBATE • Yet the Communist Party remained the unquestioned political centre. • Tiananmen in 1989 proved that economic opening did not mean acceptance of organized political opposition. • CAUTION: This is a classic UPSC contrast: marketization inside a one-party Leninist shell . • Communist victory in China transformed the balance of power in Asia.	LEGACY / NUANCE • CAUTION: For India, the relevant sequence is: 1949 PRC - 1954 Panchsheel - 1962 border war - long-term strategic caution . • CAUTION: Do not re-narrate India's China policy here; cross-link it. • 20-23 October 2025: the official communique of the CCP's Fourth Plenary Session said the meeting adopted recommendations for • the Fifteenth Five-Year Plan and continued to frame policy around high-quality development, technological capacity and centralized Party leadership.
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OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.